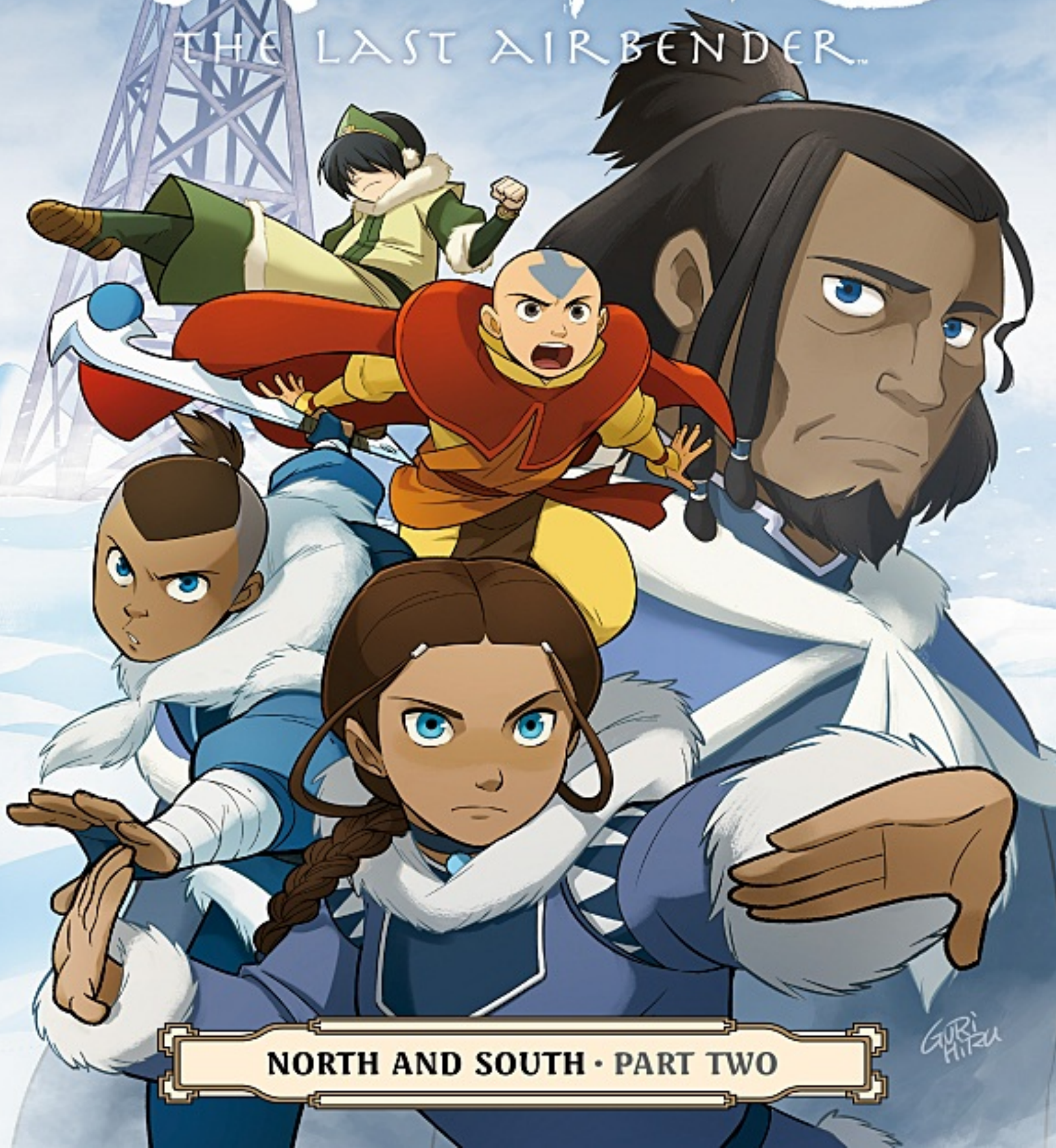


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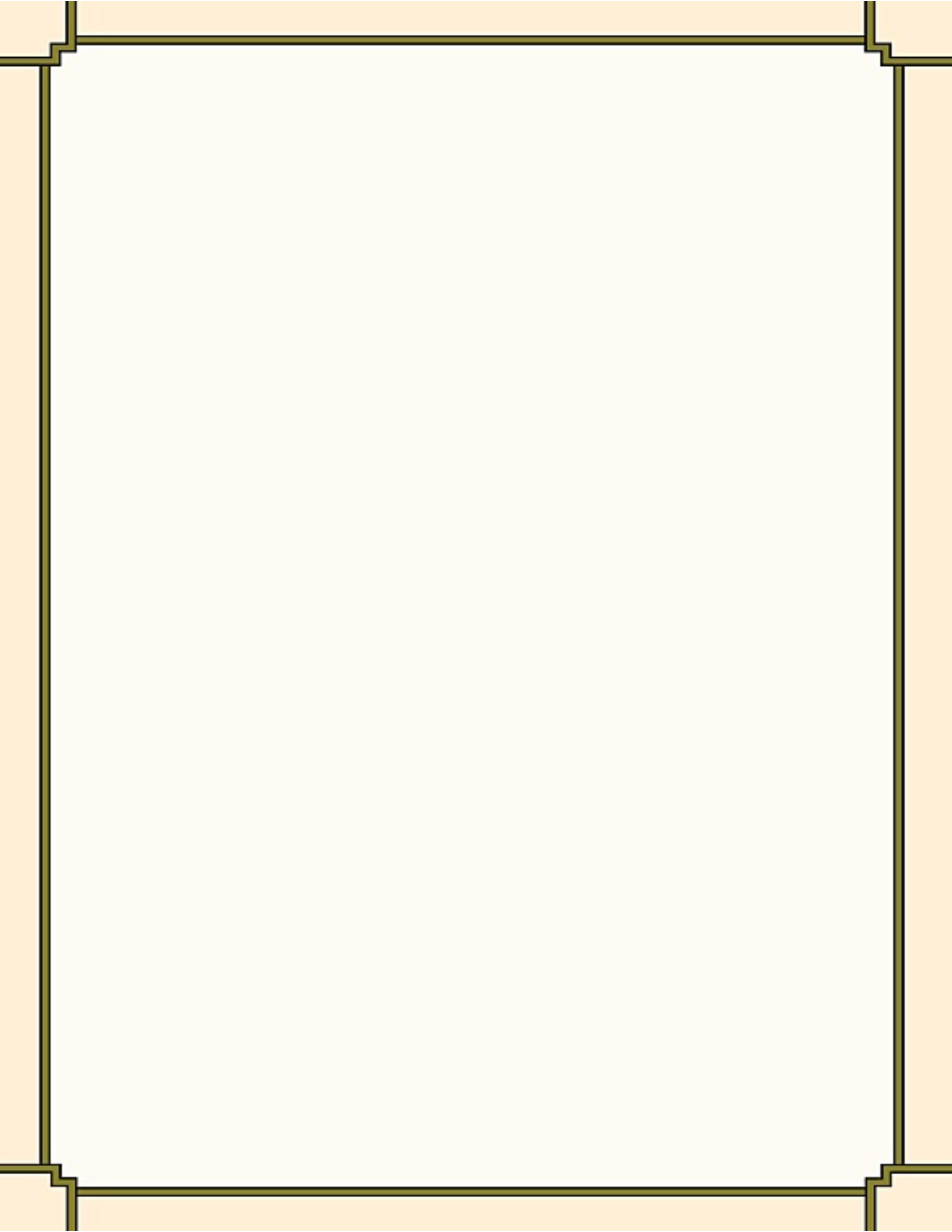
AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™



NORTH AND SOUTH • PART TWO

GURI
HIRAI



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AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™

Created by

Bryan Konietzko

Michael Dante DiMartino



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AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER™

NORTH AND SOUTH • PART TWO

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SOKKA
AND KATARA SAID
THERE'S A *WHOLE*
ARMY HIDING IN
THERE?

NOT IN
THE SHIP
ITSELF. IN THE
CAVERNS
UNDER THE
SHIP.



THE RUMORS
THAT THE SHIP
IS HAUNTED KEEP
PEOPLE AWAY, MAKING
THIS THE PERFECT
HIDING PLACE.

CLEVER.

GILAK
ALWAYS WAS
A CLEVER
ONE.



CAREFUL.



THIS
PLACE IS
LINED WITH
BOOBY
TRAPS.



HERE'S
THE ENTRANCE,
EXACTLY WHERE
THEY SAID IT
WOULD BE.



FOLLOW
MY LEAD,
OFFICERS!



酋長
吾不久將受於真相

A MESSAGE.

TRANSLATION:
SOON I WILL SHOW YOU
THE TRUTH, CHIEFTAIN.



SOKKA
AND KATARA,
I CAN'T TELL
YOU WHAT AN
ABSOLUTE
PLEASURE
THIS IS!

THANK
YOU FOR
AGREEING TO A
TOUR OF THIS
PLACE!

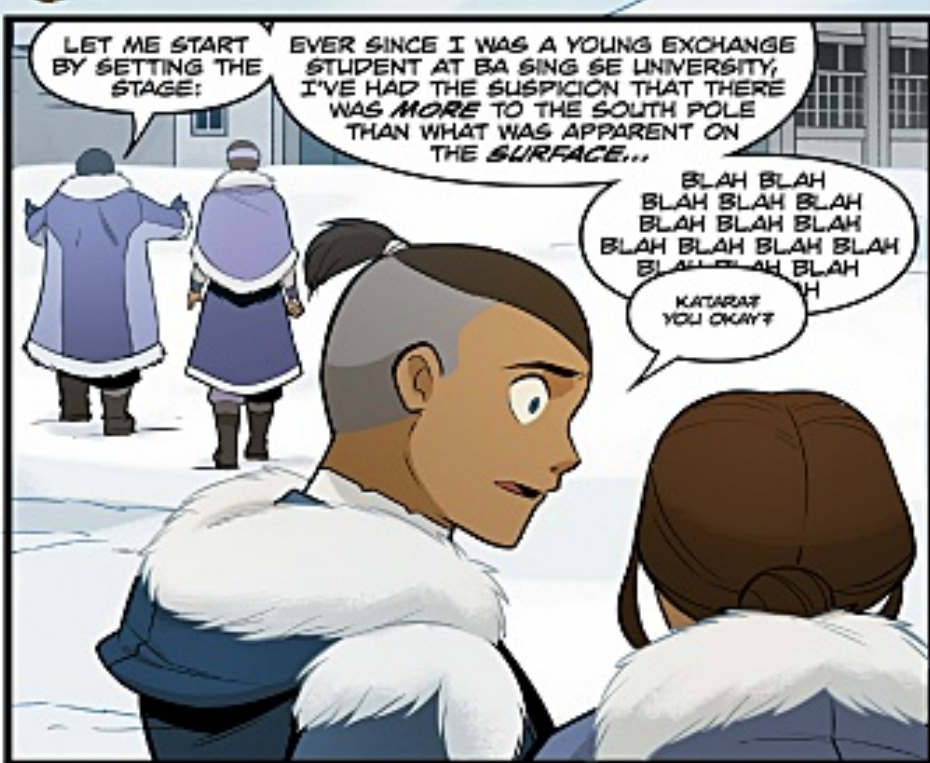
WELL,
THAT'S PART OF
A CONSULTANT'S
JOB, RIGHT?



I'VE GOTTA TAKE
A LOOK AROUND
BEFORE I CAN START
TELLING PEOPLE
WHAT TO DO.

HA HA! OH,
SOKKA! YOU'VE
GOT YOUR
FATHER'S SENSE OF
HUMOR!

I WASN'T
TRYING TO
BE FUNNY.



LET ME START
BY SETTING THE
STAGE:

EVER SINCE I WAS A YOUNG EXCHANGE
STUDENT AT BA SING SE UNIVERSITY,
I'VE HAD THE SUSPICION THAT THERE
WAS *MORE* TO THE SOUTH POLE
THAN WHAT WAS APPARENT ON
THE *SURFACE*...

BLAH BLAH
BLAH BLAH BLAH
BLAH BLAH BLAH
BLAH BLAH BLAH
BLAH BLAH BLAH

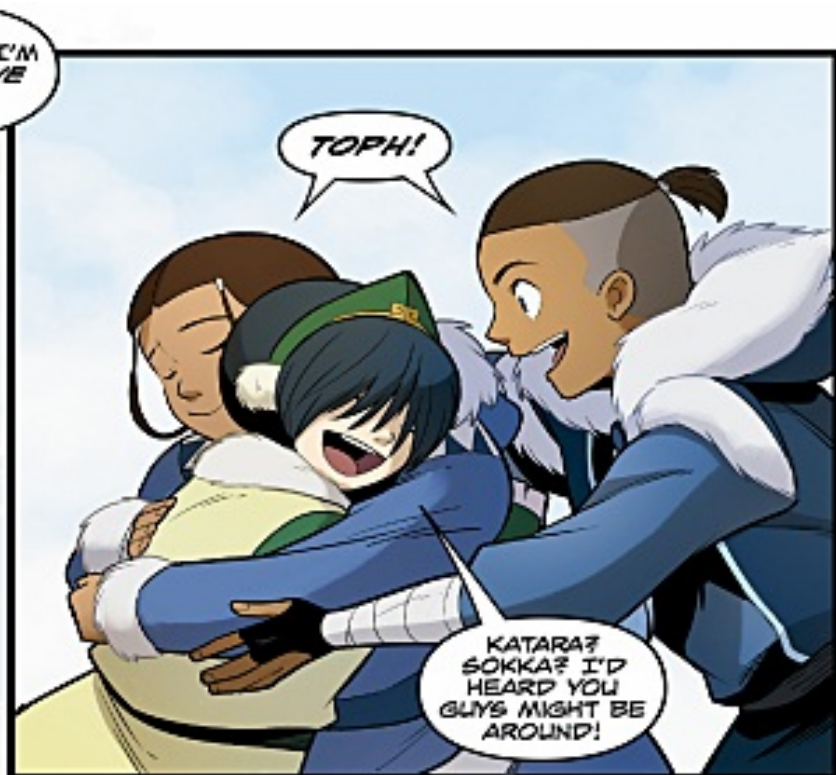
KATARAY
YOU OKAY?













CHECK.

THIS.

OUT!

THIS MIGHT
BE THE *GREATEST*
FESTIVAL IN THE HISTORY
OF SOUTHERN WATER
TRIBE FESTIVAL-ING!





EARTHEN FIRE
NEEDS TO SEND
REPRESENTATIVES
DOWN HERE MORE
OFTEN!

YOU MEAN
EXECUTIVE
PARTNERS.

==GASP!==

KLANG!

TOPH, YOU'RE
NOT GOING TO BELIEVE
THIS, BUT THEY'VE GOT
THE POUNDY-POUNDY
GAME!

LET'S
GO!

YOU
COMING,
SIS?

NO,
THANKS.

THE POUNDY-
POUNDY GAME?!
MY FAVORITE!

TIME TO
GET PAID,
SOKKA!

I DON'T THINK THAT'S
HOW IT WORKS HERE,
TOPH.

KATARAZ?



WHAT
WAS THAT
ABOUT?

THEY'VE
BEEN LIKE
THAT THE WHOLE
TIME THEY'VE
BEEN IN THE
CITY.

GRAN GRAN AND
I FOUND THEM IN
A TINY VILLAGE
EAST OF HERE.

THEY
LIVE ABOUT AS
FAR INLAND AS A
TRIBE CAN, WELL
OUT OF SIGHT
FROM THE
SHORE.

YOU
SURE THEY'RE
BENDERS?

LOOK.

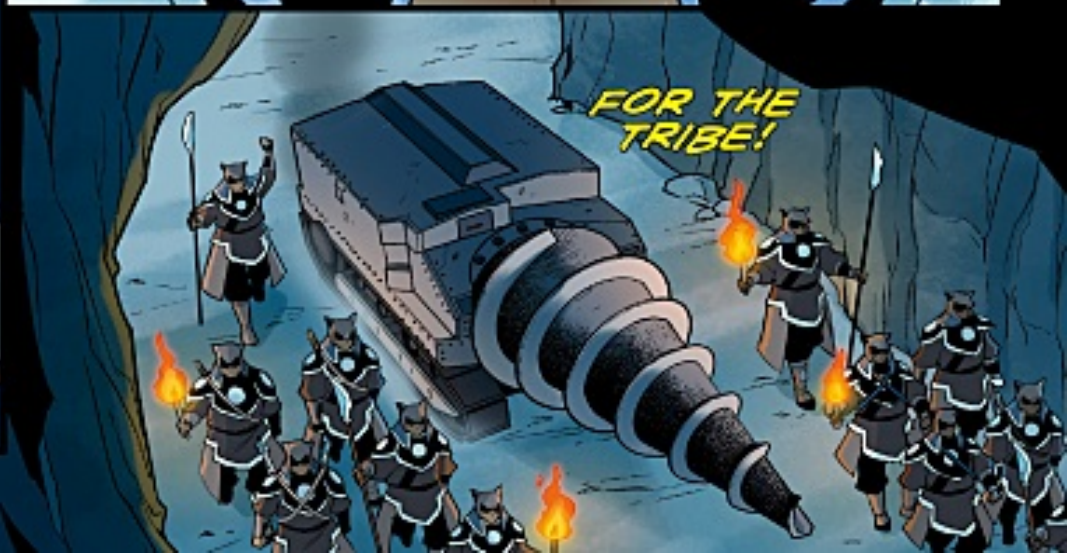
THEY'LL
DO IT WHEN
THEY THINK I'M
NOT PAYING
ATTENTION.

THEY'RE
VERY TALENTED
FOR THEIR
AGE.

IT'S LIKE
THEY DON'T WANT
TO SHARE THEIR
WATERBENDING
WITH ANYONE BUT
THEMSELVES.

GIVE ME --
SHN!E -- A SECOND.
AFTER ALL, I'M JUST
A POOR LITTLE
BLIND GIRL!











BUT ARE YOU SURE YOU'RE READY?

CAN I BE HONEST?

OF COURSE.

I DON'T GET WHY YOU'D CHOOSE HER.



I KNOW MALINA CAN COME ACROSS AS GRUFF--

IT'S NOT JUST THAT, DAD. I GET GRUFF. I'M FRIENDS WITH TOPH!



MALINA DOESN'T REALLY UNDERSTAND US.

YOU MEAN YOU AND SOKKA?

NO, I MEAN US US. THE BIG US. THE SOUTHERN WATER TRIBE.



AND HONESTLY? I DON'T TRUST HER. WHAT IF SHE'S UP TO SOMETHING... I DON'T KNOW... NEFARIOUS?



"NEFARIOUS"?



KATARA,
I ASSURE
YOU. MALINA IS
A LOT OF THINGS,
BUT *NEFARIOUS*
ISN'T ONE OF
THEM.

EVEN
IF YOU DON'T
TRUST HER, YOU
HAVE TO TRUST
ME, OKAY?



MALINA STILL
HAS A LOT TO
LEARN ABOUT OUR
WAY OF LIFE, BUT
DEEP DOWN INSIDE,
SHE HAS A *GOOD*
HEART.

I WOULDN'T
HAVE FALLEN IN
LOVE WITH HER
OTHERWISE.



BUT MAYBE
THAT'S THE PROBLEM,
DAD! NO OFFENSE, BUT
WHAT IF YOU'RE BEING
BLINDED BY YOUR
FEELINGS?

YOU'RE OLD
ENOUGH NOW THAT
WE CAN TALK ABOUT
THESE THINGS.



YOU KNOW
WHAT IT'S LIKE
TO BE *IN LOVE*,
RIGHT?

...
YEAH.





AANG!

KATARA!



I MISSED YOU SO MUCH, SWEETIE!

CAN I KISS YOU, SWEETIE?

MAYBE NOT IN FRONT OF MY DAD?

OKAY



HOW'S ZUKO DOING? WERE YOU GUYS ABLE TO GET THE SPIRITS TO SETTLE DOWN?

ACTUALLY, IT WASN'T SPIRITS AT ALL. IT WAS AZULA.

OH, NO!

BUT THINGS TURNED OUT OKAY. I'M JUST GLAD THE KYOSHI WARRIORS ARE THERE TO HELP OUT.



AVATAR AANG!

GOOD TO SEE YOU, CHIEF HAKODA!

IT'S ACTUALLY HEAD CHIEFTAIN HAKODA, NOW.

REALLY? WOW! CONGRATULATIONS, HEAD CHIEFTAIN HAKODA, SIR!

PLEASE, JUST CALL ME "HAKODA," AANG, BUT THANK YOU.













SO...
THAT'S A
GOOD THING,
RIGHT?



WHAT IS
THAT...?

I KNOW,
RIGHT? WHAT A
RIP-OFF.



NO, NOT
THAT...

UNDER-
GROUND...I
FEEL SOMETHING...
SOMEONE COMING
TOWARD US!



WOULD'VE
FELT IT SOONER
IF IT WEREN'T FOR
THESE STUPID
THINGS!



HEADS
UP, TEAM
AVATAR!

SHHH!
SOME OF US
ARE TRYING TO
LISTEN!



TONIGHT,
WE'RE THRILLED
TO ANNOUNCE A NEW
PARTNER IN THIS
VENTURE:

**EARTHEN FIRE
INDUSTRIES!**



REPRESENTATIVE
TOPH BEIFONG --

I THINK
SHE PREFERS
**EXECUTIVE
PARTNER.**

**EXECUTIVE
PARTNER TOPH
BEIFONG, WHERE
ARE YOU?**

WOULD
YOU LIKE TO
COME UP HERE
AND SAY A FEW
WORDS?



YEAH, I'D LIKE
TO SAY A FEW
WORDS!

**EVERY-
BODY GET
OUT OF
HERE!**



CRASH!







HEAR ME,
PEOPLE OF THE
SOUTHERN WATER
TRIBE! I AM *SILAK*,
YOUR TRUE
BROTHER!

MANY OF
YOU KNOW
ME!



WE
CAME OF AGE
TOGETHER!



WE'VE
SHARED MEALS
TOGETHER!



WE'VE
BLED
TOGETHER
IN FOREIGN
LANDS!



YOU
KNOW THAT I
AM *BLOOD* OF
YOUR BLOOD AND
FLESH OF YOUR
FLESH!



SO YOU MUST BELIEVE ME WHEN I TELL YOU THAT THESE TWO SCOUNDRELS FROM OUR SO-CALLED "SISTER TRIBE" ARE NOT HERE TO HELP US!

THEY ARE HERE TO **SUBJUGATE** AND **HUMILIATE** US!



THEY WANT TO **STRIP** OUR LAND AND **DESTROY** EVERYTHING WE ARE!

WHAT ARE YOU TALKING ABOUT?!



RECENTLY, THEY DISCOVERED **OIL** BENEATH OUR HOMELAND--

OIL THAT WILL BRING **PROSPERITY** TO YOUR PEOPLE!



OIL THEY'RE GOING TO CLAIM FOR THE NORTH!



WAIT, WHAT?!





...
BUT
IT USED
TO BE.

WE NEVER
USED THE WORD
"COLONY"...



...BUT WE DID
WORRY THAT THE
SOUTH WASN'T READY
TO HANDLE SUCH
AN IMPORTANT
RESOURCE.



WE WERE
WRONG.

NO! NO,
WE WEREN'T! I
TRIED TO TELL YOU,
BUT YOU WOULDN'T
LISTEN, MALINA!

I NEVER
DESTROYED THOSE
DOCUMENTS!



I NEVER
CANCELED THE
PLANS!

WHAT?!

YOU
WOULDN'T
FOUND OUT
SOONER OR
LATER.



AS WOULD YOU ALL, SO I MAY AS WELL TELL YOU NOW!

THE MAN IN THAT... THAT **RIDICULOUS** TRIBAL GETUP SPEAKS THE **TRUTH!**

MALIQ! WHAT ARE YOU DOING?!

ONCE THAT OIL IS OUT OF THE GROUND--



-- IT WILL BE UNDER **NORTHERN CONTROL!**

COME ON, BOYS. I GOT A FEELING MALINA AND MALIQ ARE GONNA NEED US.



IT'S WHAT **HAS** TO BE DONE!

WHAT HE'S SAYING ISN'T TRUE!



CAN YOU BELIEVE THE GALL OF THESE NORTHERNERS?!

DURING THE WAR, OUR **BLOOD** KEPT THEM **SAFE!**

AND AS IF THAT WASN'T ENOUGH, NOW THEY WANT OUR **OIL** TO MAKE THEM **RICH!**

YOU THINK THIS IS ABOUT **MONEY?**!



YOU HAVE NO IDEA WHAT THIS OIL MEANS, NOT JUST FOR YOUR OWN LITTLE **BACKWARD SOCIETY**, BUT FOR THE **WORLD!**

MALIQ!



THIS OIL CHANGES **EVERYTHING!**

STOP!

THIS OIL IS OUR PATHWAY TO A FUTURE OF EQUALITY! AND WE CAN'T TRUST THE FUTURE TO A CULTURE SO Mired IN THE PAST!

PLEASE...

YOU SOUTHERNERS NEED THE OVERSIGHT OF AN ACTUAL CIVILIZATION!

YOU ALL CAN'T EVEN COME UP WITH A COHESIVE SET OF LAWS--

STOP TALKING!

PEOPLE OF THE SOUTHERN WATER TRIBE, I DEEPLY REGRET THE HURT THAT MY CREW AND I HAVE CAUSED.

WE ARE STEPPING DOWN FROM THE SOUTHERN RECONSTRUCTION PROJECT, EFFECTIVE IMMEDIATELY.

WE'LL LEAVE THE SOUTH POLE FIRST THING IN THE MORNING.

OH, NO. AFTER WHAT YOU'VE DONE, YOU DON'T GET TO JUST LEAVE.



FOR THE
TRIBE!

FOR THE TRIBE!

MALIQ, I
TOLD YOU TO
STAY QUIET!
STAY
BEHIND
ME!













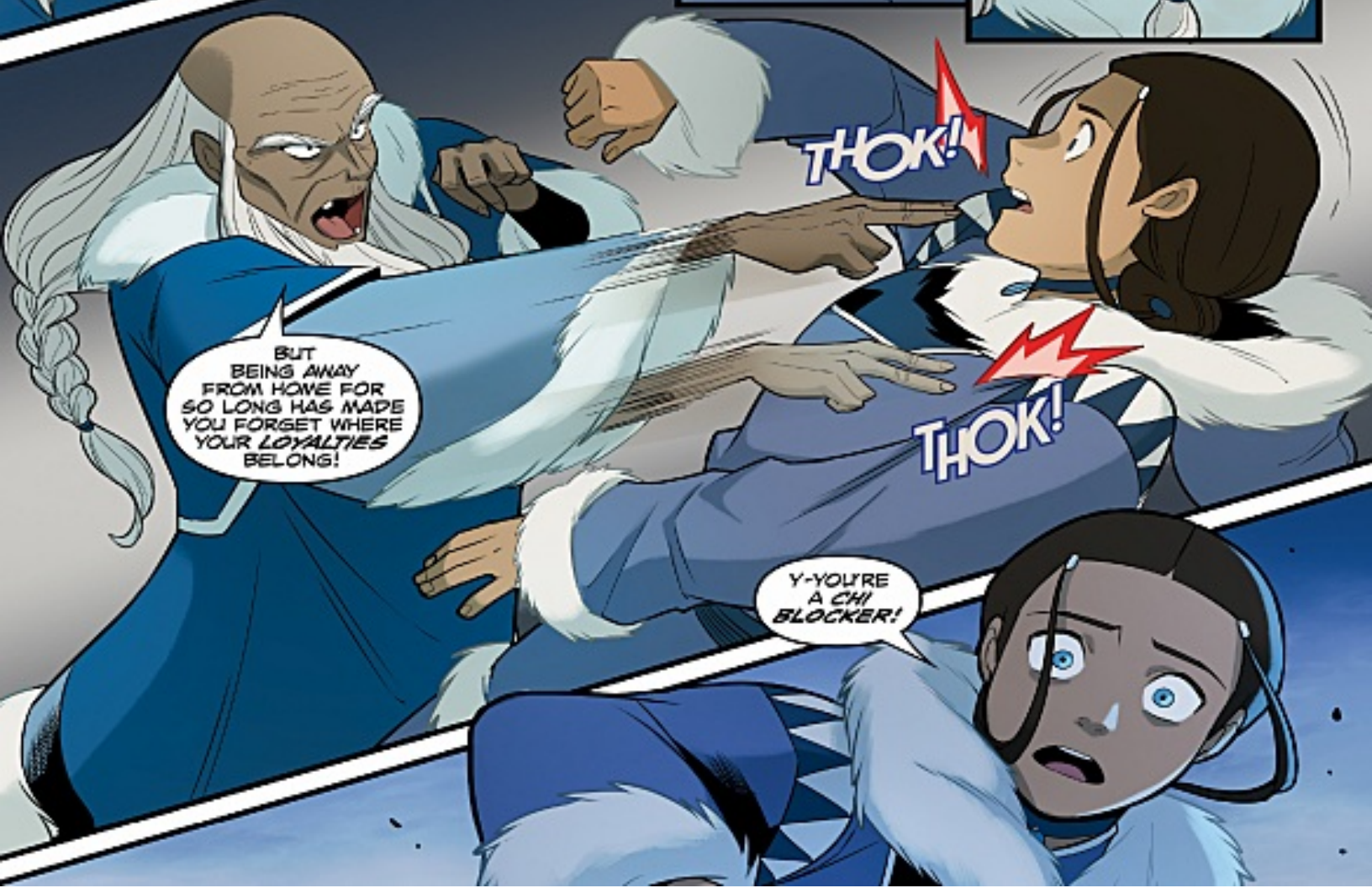


NO.



251518E

I BELIEVED
IN YOU, YOUNG
KATARA, I REALLY
DID.



BUT
BEING AWAY
FROM HOME FOR
SO LONG HAS MADE
YOU FORGET WHERE
YOUR LOYALTIES
BELONG!

Y-YOURE
A CHI
BLOCKER!











BETTER THAN YOU AS A BOOMER-ANGER?

ABSOLUTELY!



-- CAPTAIN BOOMERANGS!











THOK!

THOK!

MY
BROTHER DIDN'T
KNOW WHAT HE WAS
SAYING! FORGIVE HIM,
GILAK! FORGIVE THE
BOTH OF US!

FORGIVENESS
BETWEEN FAMILY
IS EASY.

BUT
YOU AREN'T
FAMILY, ARE YOU?
YOU MAY LOOK LIKE US
AND DRESS LIKE US,
BUT YOU WERE NEVER
A PART OF THE
TRIBE.

CHI
BLOCKING.
IMPRESSIVE.

THOD
TAUGHT US
WELL, MASTER
GILAK.



NOW THE
TRIBE NEEDS
THE TWO OF YOU
TO SERVE AS AN
EXAMPLE.

NO...!

YOUR
DEMISE WILL BE
A WARNING TO ALL
FOREIGN POWERS
WHO THINK THEY CAN
COME TRAMPLE OVER
OUR PEOPLE--

-- THAT
THEY NEED
TO THINK
AGAIN!



LET
THEM GO,
GILAK!

HAKODA!

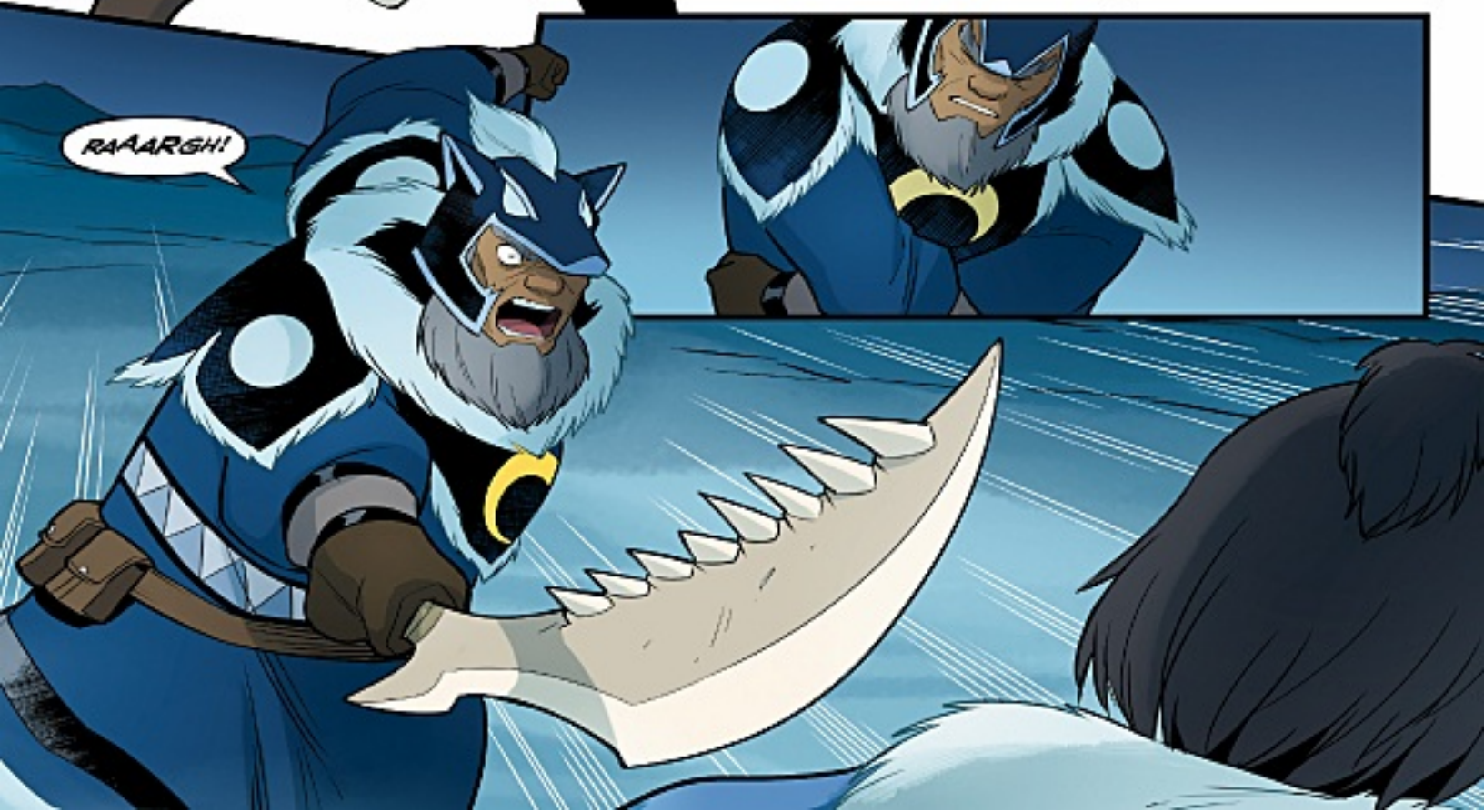
HEAR ME
OUT, BROTHER!
I HAVE *PROOF*
THAT --

-- THAT WHEN
MALINA FIRST
CAME HERE, SHE'D
PLANNED TO BRING US
UNDER *NORTHERN*
CONTROL. I
KNOW.

WHAT?!
THEN HOW
CAN YOU
DEFEND
HER?!

BECAUSE
AFTER SHE GOT
TO KNOW OUR PEOPLE,
SHE CHANGED HER
MIND.







GILAK, DO YOU REMEMBER WHALE TAIL ISLAND?

YES, OF COURSE. THOSE TWO FIRE NATION GUARDS GOT THE JUMP ON YOU --

--AND I ALMOST BROKE MY NECK TRYING TO ESCAPE.



BUT THEN YOU SAVED ME. AND WE DEFEATED THOSE TWO GUARDS TOGETHER.

DESPITE ALL THAT'S HAPPENED IN THE LAST COUPLE OF DAYS, THAT'S HOW I THINK OF YOU STILL. THAT'S WHO YOU ARE TO ME.



SO LET'S TALK THIS THROUGH, GILAK, AS BROTHERS.



YES... YOU'RE RIGHT...

--BROTHER!

RGH!





NOOO!

DAD!

WHAT
DID YOU DO
TO HIM?

KROOOOSH!

IT'S THAT
WATERBENDER
GIRL AGAIN!

RUN!

















GILAK.





Rebellion on the horizon!

After attempting to kidnap Katara and Sokka, Southerner Gilak has disappeared, leaving only a haunting note in the deserted caverns: "Soon you will see the truth, Chieftain." The vow leaves everyone on edge and prompts Hakoda to tighten security around the city. Still reeling from the discovery that her father is romantically involved with Malina, Katara is more distrusting of the Northern newcomer than ever . . . and just as everyone begins to relax their guard, Gilak's crew strikes and reveals some troubling information. Have Katara's worst fears been confirmed?

Writer Gene Luen Yang and artists Gurihiru, the team behind bestsellers *The Promise*, *The Search*, *The Rift*, and *Smoke and Shadow*, are back again! Developed in close collaboration with *Avatar: The Last Airbender* and *The Legend of Korra* creators Michael Dante DiMartino and Bryan Konietzko, this is the definitive continuation of the beloved TV series!

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